

HOVID CARBIMAZOLE TABLET 5 mg

VICAR01-M

DESCRIPTION

Round, pink, uncoated tablet with deep convex faces.

COMPOSITION

Carbimazole 5 mg/tablet

ACTIONS AND PHARMACOLOGY

Carbimazole is an antithyroid agent which depresses the formation of thyroid hormone. Its main effect is to reduce the formation of iodotyrosines and hence of tri-iodothyronine and thyroxine. It is rapidly absorbed orally and completely excreted in the urine in 24 hours as the metabolite methimazole.

PHARMACOKINETICS

The pharmacokinetics of Carbimazole and methimazole [thiamazole] can be considered together since Carbimazole is rapidly and completely metabolised to methimazole [thiamazole] in the body. The antithyroid activity of Carbimazole is dependent upon this conversion to methimazole [thiamazole].

Carbimazole and other thiourea antithyroid drugs are rapidly absorbed from the gastrointestinal tract with peak plasma concentrations occurring 1 to 2 hours following administration by mouth.

They are concentrated in the thyroid gland and, since their duration of action is more closely related to the intrathyroidal drug concentration than their plasma half-life, this results in a prolongation of antithyroid activity such that single daily doses are possible. Methimazole [thiamazole] is not bound to plasma proteins.

Methimazole [thiamazole] has an elimination half-life from plasma of about 3 to 6 hours and is metabolised, probably by the liver, and excreted in the urine. Less than 12% of a dose of Methimazole [thiamazole] may be excreted as unchanged drug. 3-Methyl-2-thio-hydantoin has been identified as a metabolite of methimazole [thiamazole]. The elimination half-life may be increased in hepatic and renal impairment. Methimazole [thiamazole] crosses the placenta and is distributed into breast milk.

INDICATIONS

For treatment of hyperthyroidism, including prior to surgery or radiotherapy; as well as concomitant therapy with radio-iodine treatment.

CONTRAINDICATIONS

Breast feeding should not be undertaken by lactating patients.

PRECAUTIONS

- Caution in patients with bone marrow depression, hepatic function impairment or infection.
- Use of minimum effective dose during pregnancy is recommended.
- It should be given with caution if there is any degree of tracheal obstruction.
- Cross-sensitivity with other antithyroid agents may sometimes occur.

WARNING

Carbimazole may cause white cell disorders such as neutropenia and agranulocytosis, which may be fatal if treatment with carbimazole is not stopped promptly. These reactions usually occur during the first 3 months of therapy, and in most cases, are reversible on stopping treatment. Since agranulocytosis can develop very rapidly, periodic leukocyte counts alone may not be effective in the early detection of these reactions.

During treatment with carbimazole :

1. The patient should be asked to immediately report signs and symptoms suggestive of infection, e.g. sore throat, fever, mouth ulcers.
2. A white cell count should be performed if there is any clinical evidence of infection.
3. The drug should be stopped promptly if there is clinical or laboratory evidence of neutropenia.

MAIN SIDE/ADVERSE EFFECTS

Skin rash, nausea, headache, gastrointestinal upsets, joint pains, agranulocytosis.

DRUG INTERACTIONS AND INCOMPATIBILITIES

- Concurrent use with anticoagulants and heparin is not recommended.
- Concurrent use with agranulocytosis producing medications may increase the risk of agranulocytosis.

PREGNANCY AND LACTATION

- Use of minimum effective dose during pregnancy is recommended.
- Breast feeding should not be undertaken by lactating patients.

OVERDOSE

No symptoms are likely from a single large dose and so no specific treatment is indicated.

DOSAGE AND ADMINISTRATION

Adults: Oral, 30-60 mg daily in divided doses every 8 hours, the dosage being gradually reduced to the smallest effective dose, usually 5 to 20 mg daily.

Children: Oral, 2.5-10 mg every 8 hours, the dosage being reduced gradually according to the clinical response.

Note: The information given here is limited. For further information consult your doctor or pharmacist.

Storage : Store below 25°C. Protect from light.
Presentation/Packing : Tablet 5 mg x 100's, 500's, 1000's.
Blister 5 x 20's

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Manufactured by: HOVID Bhd.
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